slaves in its territories and to punish those caught transporting slaves. However, that seemingly progressive action has to be set in context: the EICo had itself been involved in the East African slave trade for the best part of a century from 1693 onwards, chiefly in order to stock its pepper plantation at Benkulen in Sumatra with labour. While never as active as Portuguese or Dutch slavers, the British authorities in Madras took full advantage of two bouts of widespread famine and social disorder throughout the Deccan in 1782–4 and 1790–93 to buy up young children from destitute families, along with slaves from the local rulers of Tanjore and Madurai, for shipping east.

14 W. T. Ringeltaube to Col. John Munro, Quilon, 30 March 1818. Quoted in I. H. Hacker, *A hundred years in Travancore, 1806–1906: a history and description of the work done by The London Missionary Society in Travancore, South India during the past century*, 1908.

15 G. D'Arcy Wood, *Tambora: the Eruption that Changed the World*, 2014.

16 Quoted in Robin Jeffrey, *The Decline of Nayar Dominance: Society and Politics in Travancore 1847–1908*, 1976.

17 Swami Vivekananda, *The Complete Works of Swami Vivekananda*, Vol. I, from comments made during a public address in Madras in 1897.

18 Wikipedia, Padmanabhaswamy Vishnu temple – sources cited there and contemporary newspaper reports.

CHAPTER 10: TIPPOO'S TIGER

1 For example, the Philadelphia Museum of Art caption for image 199-148-401 says: 'This vision of Kamadhenu, the wish-granting cow of ancient Hindu legend, combines a white zebu cow with the crowned, frontal female face, colorful "eagle" wings, and peacock tail of Buraq, the